



Leadership & Influence

Quick Reference Guide

Your transformational leadership operating system for building high-performance teams, driving accountability, and creating lasting impact. Keep this guide accessible during team meetings, one-on-ones, and critical leadership moments—these frameworks separate exceptional leaders from mere managers.



The 3 Levels of Leadership Maturity

Leadership evolution isn't about titles—it's about the depth of your influence and the transformation you create in others. Understanding where you operate on this spectrum is the first step toward building a legacy that outlasts your tenure.



Level 1: Positional Leadership

People follow you because they have to. This is title-based authority where compliance comes from organizational hierarchy, not genuine influence. Your power exists only within formal structures and disappears the moment you leave the role.



Level 2: Relational Leadership

People follow you because they want to. You've built trust-based influence through consistent actions, authentic connection, and demonstrated care. Your team members choose to engage because they believe in you as a person, not just a position.



Level 3: Transformational Leadership

People follow you because of who you help them become. This is vision-based empowerment where your leadership unlocks potential, develops capabilities, and creates new leaders. This is where legacy lives—in the leaders you develop and the lasting impact you create.

📌 Your Goal: Operate at Level 3 in every interaction. Transformational leadership compounds over time, creating ripple effects that extend far beyond your immediate team and tenure.

The 3-Part Vision Formula

Great leaders paint pictures of the future so compelling that people willingly leave their comfort zones to pursue them. Vision isn't abstract inspiration—it's a specific, structured communication that connects current reality to future possibility through meaningful purpose.

Part 1: Where We Are

Honest assessment of current reality with no sugarcoating. Your team needs to understand the truth before they can embrace change. Acknowledge challenges, celebrate progress, and establish a credible baseline that builds trust in your perspective.

Part 2: Where We're Going

Compelling picture of the future state that's specific and inspiring. Vague aspirations create confusion—detailed visions create alignment. Paint a vivid picture that people can see, feel, and imagine themselves contributing to with clarity and conviction.

Part 3: Why It Matters

The purpose that makes the journey meaningful through emotional connection. Logic informs, but emotion motivates. Connect your vision to personal values, team identity, and impact that extends beyond quarterly metrics to create sustained commitment.

Communicate your vision 7x more than you think necessary. What feels like repetition to you is clarity for your team. Repetition doesn't dilute vision—it reinforces, refines, and embeds it into organizational consciousness.





The Trust Equation™

Trust is the currency of leadership. Without it, every initiative faces resistance, every message gets questioned, and every decision requires exhausting justification. The Trust Equation provides a diagnostic framework for understanding and building the foundation of all leadership influence.

$$\text{Trust} = (\text{Credibility} + \text{Reliability} + \text{Intimacy}) \div \text{Self-Orientation}$$

The Numerator: What Builds Trust

Credibility: Do you know what you're talking about? This is competence—your expertise, knowledge, and demonstrated capability in your domain. People follow leaders who understand the landscape.

Reliability: Do you do what you say you'll do? This is consistency—the alignment between your commitments and actions. Every promise kept is a deposit; every promise broken is a withdrawal.

Intimacy: Do you care about your people? This is connection—the genuine human relationship that transcends transactional interactions. People trust leaders who see them as people, not resources.

The Denominator: What Destroys Trust

Self-Orientation: Are you serving yourself or serving others? This is motive—the perceived intention behind your decisions. The lower your self-orientation, the higher your trust. Leaders focused on personal advancement erode trust faster than any other factor.



❏ Action Item: Rate yourself 1-10 on each dimension monthly. Track improvement over time. What gets measured gets managed—including your trustworthiness as a leader.

The 3 Cs of Leadership Communication™

Communication is the delivery system for everything you do as a leader. Vision, strategy, feedback, and accountability all fail without exceptional communication. Master these three dimensions and you master the fundamental tool of leadership influence.

1. Clear

Simple language. No jargon. No ambiguity. Your team cannot execute what they don't understand. Complexity signals insecurity—clarity signals leadership. Strip away corporate speak and communicate with precision and directness that leaves no room for misinterpretation.

2. Consistent

Same message, multiple channels, repeated often. Consistency builds trust because it demonstrates conviction and stability. When your message changes with each audience or context, people question your authenticity and commitment to the direction.

3. Compelling

Connects to emotion, purpose, and personal benefit. Logic makes people think—emotion makes them act. The best communications answer both "What are we doing?" and "Why should I care?" with equal power and specificity.

The Communication Formula: "We're doing [initiative] because [purpose]. This matters to you because [personal benefit]. Here's what I need you to do: [clear action]." This structure ensures you've addressed logic, emotion, and execution in every important message.

The 4 Levels of Delegation

Delegation isn't dumping—it's development. The level at which you delegate reveals both your trust in team members and your commitment to their growth. Exceptional leaders match delegation levels to individual competence and commitment, creating a pathway for progressive empowerment.

1

Level 1: Do and Report

"Do exactly what I say and report back." Use this for low trust or low competence situations. Provides structure and safety while building foundational skills. This is training ground, not permanent assignment.

2

Level 2: Research and Recommend

"Research options and recommend a course of action." Building competence through analytical thinking. They do the work, you make the decision. This develops judgment while maintaining control during the learning phase.

3

Level 3: Decide and Inform

"Make the decision and let me know what you decided." High trust delegation where they own the outcome. This is where real empowerment begins—they lead, you support. Most high performers should operate here.

4

Level 4: Act Independently

"You own this. I trust your judgment." Full empowerment for proven performers. They don't need your approval or input—they need your air cover and resources. This creates leaders, not followers.

The art of delegation is matching the level to the person's competence and commitment for each specific domain. Someone might be Level 4 in operations but Level 2 in strategy. Calibrate accordingly and communicate explicitly about which level you're using.



The SBI Feedback Model™



Feedback is the breakfast of champions, but most leaders serve it cold and late. The SBI model provides structure that makes feedback specific, actionable, and focused on behavior rather than personality. This framework removes ambiguity and creates clarity for improvement.

01

Situation

Describe the specific situation: when and where the behavior occurred. Specificity prevents defensiveness.

02

Behavior

Describe the observable behavior: exactly what they did or said. Focus on actions, not interpretations.

03

Impact

Describe the impact: how it affected results or people. This connects behavior to consequences.

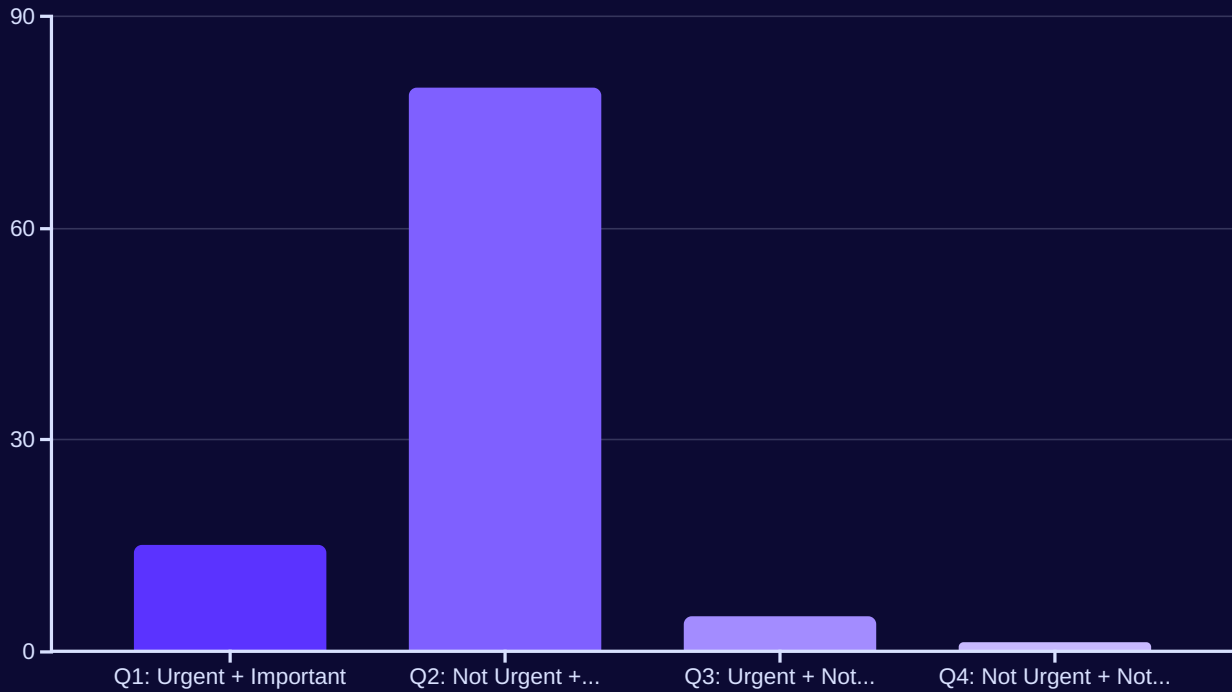


"In yesterday's client meeting (Situation), you interrupted the client three times (Behavior), which made them visibly frustrated and we lost the deal (Impact)."

❏ Pro Tip: Deliver feedback within 24 hours while it's fresh and specific. Delayed feedback loses impact and feels like an ambush. Timely feedback is a gift—late feedback is a weapon.

The Eisenhower Matrix™

Your calendar reveals your priorities. Most leaders spend their days in reactive mode, responding to urgent demands while strategic opportunities go unaddressed. The Eisenhower Matrix is a forcing function for intentional time allocation—the difference between managing your time and letting your time manage you.



1

Quadrant 1: Urgent + Important

Do it now. Crisis management, deadlines, emergencies. These demand immediate attention but shouldn't dominate your schedule. If you live here, you're firefighting, not leading.

2

Quadrant 2: Not Urgent + Important

Schedule it. Strategy, planning, development, relationships. This is where leadership happens. Spend 80% of your time here. This quadrant builds the future and prevents Quadrant 1 crises.

3

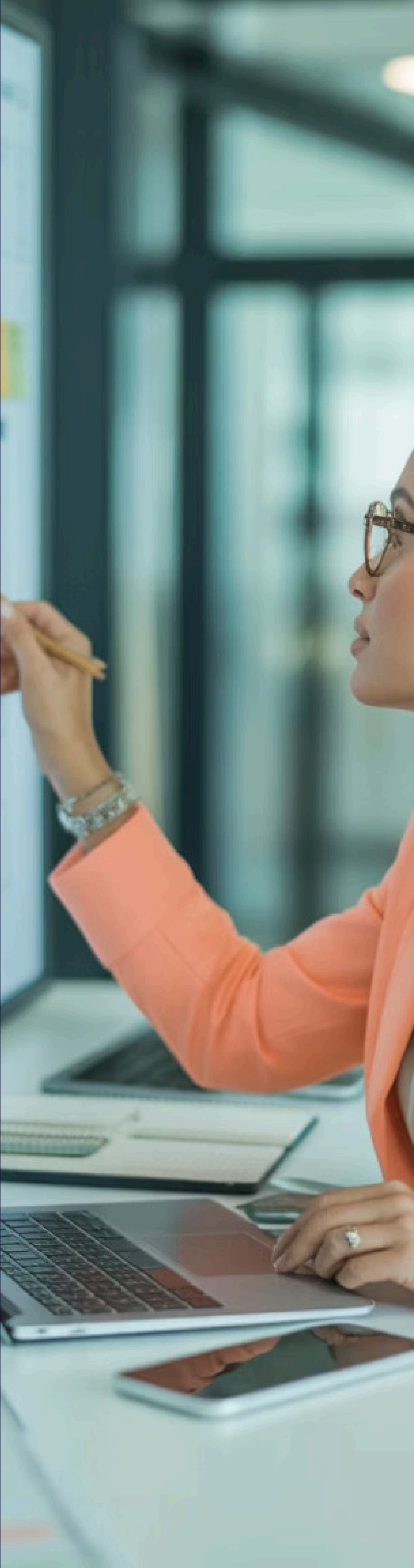
Quadrant 3: Urgent + Not Important

Delegate it. Interruptions, some emails, some calls. These feel important because they're urgent, but they're not. Train your team to handle these or eliminate them entirely.

4

Quadrant 4: Not Urgent + Not Important

Eliminate it. Time wasters, busy work, distractions. These activities provide neither urgency nor value. Cut them ruthlessly. Your time is your most precious resource—protect it fiercely.



The 5 Elements of Accountability™

Accountability is the difference between good intentions and great results. Without these five elements in place, you don't have accountability—you have hope, ambiguity, and eventual disappointment. True accountability requires structure, not just expectation.

Clear Expectations

What does success look like?
Define the outcome with specificity that eliminates interpretation. Vague expectations guarantee disappointment.

Consequences

What happens if it's done? What happens if it's not? Both positive and negative consequences must be clear and consistently applied.
Accountability without consequences is theater.

Agreed Timeline

When will it be done? Deadlines create urgency and focus. Without time boundaries, important work gets delayed indefinitely by urgent demands.

Defined Metrics

How will we measure it?
Quantifiable outcomes prevent subjective evaluation. Metrics turn opinions into facts and create objective standards.

Regular Check-Ins

How often will we review progress? Scheduled touchpoints maintain momentum and catch problems early. Accountability isn't one conversation—it's a rhythm.

Without these five elements fully defined and explicitly communicated, you don't have accountability—you have hope. Hope is not a strategy, and assumptions are not agreements.

The 3-Step Conflict Resolution Model™

Conflict avoided is conflict delayed—and delayed conflict compounds with interest. Exceptional leaders lean into conflict with structure and skill, transforming tension into clarity and stronger relationships. This three-step model provides the framework for productive conflict navigation.

Step 1: Listen to Understand

Not to respond, not to defend, not to solve—to genuinely understand their perspective. Ask questions: "Tell me your perspective." "What's most important to you here?" "Help me understand what you're experiencing." Most conflicts dissolve when people feel truly heard.

Step 2: Find Common Ground

Identify shared goals or values that both parties care about. "We both want [shared goal]. Can we agree on that?" Common ground shifts the dynamic from adversarial to collaborative. You're not enemies—you're partners solving a shared problem from different perspectives.

Step 3: Co-Create the Solution

Involve them in building the answer together. "What would a win-win solution look like?" "How can we move forward together?" Solutions imposed create compliance. Solutions co-created generate commitment. The best resolution is one they help design.

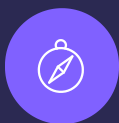
Remember: Conflict is not the problem—avoidance is. Healthy organizations have conflict. Dysfunctional organizations have unresolved conflict or artificial harmony that masks underlying tension. Your job is to create safe spaces for productive disagreement.



The 3 Pillars of High-Performance Culture™



Culture isn't what you say in town halls or write on wall posters—it's what you tolerate, reward, and model every single day. These three pillars provide the architecture for intentionally building culture rather than accidentally inheriting it.



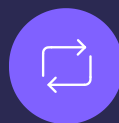
Values

What do we stand for? These are non-negotiable principles that guide decisions when the path isn't clear. Real values cost something—if everyone would naturally agree, they're not values, they're platitudes. Values create boundaries and identity.



Behaviors

What do we do? Observable actions that reflect values in daily work. Values without behaviors are abstract. Behaviors translate principles into practices. "Respect" becomes "We listen without interrupting in meetings." Specificity drives culture.



Rituals

How do we reinforce it? Recurring practices that embed culture through repetition and ceremony. Weekly recognition, monthly learning sessions, quarterly celebrations—rituals make culture tangible and memorable. Culture lives in habits, not handbooks.



❏ Culture is not what you say—it's what you tolerate, reward, and model. Every time you ignore a cultural violation, you've just established a new standard. Your silence is a statement. Your actions define culture more than your words ever will.

The One-on-One Meeting Framework

One-on-ones are the highest-leverage activity for leaders, yet most treat them as status updates or skip them when things get busy. This framework transforms one-on-ones from transactional check-ins into transformational development conversations. Thirty minutes weekly is the difference between retention and resignation.



Frequency: Weekly for direct reports. Bi-weekly minimum. Canceling one-on-ones sends a message that your team isn't a priority. Protect this time like you protect client meetings—because developing your people IS your most important client work.





Key Leadership Metrics & Time Audit

What gets measured gets managed. What gets managed gets improved. Exceptional leaders track their leadership behaviors with the same rigor they apply to business metrics. These measurements create accountability and reveal patterns that drive continuous improvement.

Leadership Metrics to Track Daily

100%

**One-on-ones
completed**

Target: All direct reports weekly. Track completion rate and quality. This is your most important recurring meeting—treat it accordingly.

2-3

**Feedback
conversations**

Target: 2-3 per day. Both positive recognition and developmental coaching. Feedback is continuous, not saved for annual reviews.

1-2

**Strategic
decisions made**

Target: 1-2 per day. Decisions that move the business forward, not just keep it running. Leadership is about direction, not administration.

Daily

**Vision
communicated**

Target: Daily in some form. Vision requires repetition. Every interaction is an opportunity to reinforce where you're going and why it matters.

The Leadership Time Audit

High-Value Activities (80% of time)

- Strategic planning and decision-making
- Developing your people (one-on-ones, coaching, feedback)
- Communicating vision and aligning the team
- Building relationships with key stakeholders
- Removing obstacles for high performers
- Creating systems and processes for scale

Low-Value Activities (Minimize or eliminate)

- Administrative tasks that can be delegated
- Meetings without clear outcomes or decisions
- Firefighting that could have been prevented
- Busy work that doesn't move the needle
- Email marathons that could be brief conversations
- Status updates that don't require your presence

📅 Action: Audit your calendar weekly. Are you spending time like a leader or a manager? Block time for high-value activities before reactive demands fill your schedule. If it's not on your calendar, it won't happen.

Your Leadership Operating System

Leadership is not a position—it's a practice. These frameworks, metrics, and mindsets constitute your operating system for transformational leadership. Excellence comes from daily discipline, not occasional inspiration. The difference between good leaders and great leaders is consistency of application.

The Leadership Mindset Shifts

- 1

From: "I need to have all the answers"
To: "I need to ask better questions." Your job is to develop thinking, not do all the thinking. Questions unlock potential that answers never could.
- 2

From: "My job is to solve problems"
To: "My job is to develop problem-solvers." Every problem you solve makes you busier. Every problem-solver you develop makes you more scalable.
- 3

From: "I need to be the smartest person in the room"
To: "I need to hire people smarter than me." Your ego is the ceiling on your team's potential. Great leaders are secure enough to be surrounded by greatness.
- 4

From: "Failure is bad"
To: "Failure is feedback." Organizations that punish failure get risk-averse teams. Organizations that learn from failure get innovative teams. Choose wisely.
- 5

From: "I'm responsible for results"
To: "I'm responsible for creating the conditions for results." You can't control outcomes, but you can control culture, systems, and support. Focus there.

Your Daily Leadership Ritual

- Morning (5 minutes)**

Review today's leadership priorities. Identify one person to develop today. Visualize successful leadership moments. Set intention before execution.
- End of Day (5 minutes)**

Log leadership activities. Celebrate one win. Identify one lesson learned. Plan tomorrow's high-value activities. Reflection turns experience into wisdom.
- Weekly (15 minutes)**

Review team health metrics. Analyze what worked and what didn't. Adjust approach for next week. Consistency compounds—small daily disciplines create massive results.

Final Reminders

- Leadership is influence, not authority.** Your title doesn't make you a leader—your impact does. Influence is earned through consistent actions, not granted through org charts.

People don't leave companies, they leave leaders. Your team's retention is a reflection of your leadership. Every resignation is feedback. Listen to it.

The speed of the leader is the speed of the team. Model the behavior you want to see. Your team watches what you do far more than they listen to what you say.
- Leadership is a practice, not a position.** You become a better leader through daily discipline, not occasional inspiration. Mastery comes from repetition.

Your legacy is not what you build—it's who you develop. The leaders you create will outlast any project or product. Invest accordingly.

Trust is built in drops and lost in buckets. Protect it fiercely. One violation can undo months of deposits. Your reputation is your most valuable asset.

Keep this guide visible. Print it. Reference it before every team meeting. Review it weekly. These frameworks are your leadership operating system. Master them through consistent application, and you'll never struggle to lead again. Welcome to the top 1%.

